

PRIMARY — Game Proposal

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Game Overview

PRIMARY is a stylized 2D action-puzzle platformer set in a world inspired by comic books and traditional print, built from halftone dots, strong outlines, comic-style effects and CMYK-inspired colours. At the start, almost all colour and light have disappeared. The player wakes in a dark, nearly monochrome world and discovers that the fundamental sources of colour and light have been scattered across it. The objective is to recover the lost CMYK Light Orbs and gradually restore colour to the world. Each colour changes how the player moves, interacts with the environment, solves puzzles and fights enemies.

Light changes the world. Colour changes the player. And restoring everything may come at a cost.

Core Gameplay Concept

The player begins with very limited abilities in a dark world where most objects and paths are inactive. When a colour (e.g. Cyan, found early) is activated, objects built from that colour's halftone pattern become interactable: faded platforms turn solid, switches activate, new paths appear and obstacles can be manipulated. Every Light Orb also grants a unique ability:

- **Cyan** – extremely slippery movement to build momentum and slide through areas.
- **Magenta** – dash / burst movement.
- **Yellow** – increased jump height.
- **Black (Key)** – interact with shadows, hidden platforms and darker parts of the environment.

Gaining a colour doesn't just unlock an area; it changes how the player approaches movement and puzzles. Later, effects must be combined, e.g. using Cyan to gain momentum, then Yellow to clear a large gap. Every new colour expands both the player's abilities and the complexity of the world.

Combat and Colour Interaction

Enemies are also built from halftone colour patterns. Instead of being worn down by repeated attacks, they are defeated by using the appropriate complementary colour or colour interaction, e.g. a mostly-Yellow enemy requires the colour that counters Yellow. Later enemies combine colours, forcing ability switching mid-combat. Bosses may shift their colour composition during the fight, demanding continuous adaptation. Colour is central to both combat and puzzles.

Game Flow

1. The Dark World

The game opens in an almost completely dark, desaturated starting area with basic movement and minimal interaction. Halftone textures, strong outlines and exaggerated comic effects establish the art style immediately. The player discovers the first Light Orb, introducing the core mechanic.

2. Recovering the Colours

Each major section holds one missing Light Orb. Each new orb introduces a new colour in the world, a new ability, new interactable objects, new enemy types and new puzzle mechanics. Earlier areas contain paths only reachable with later colours, encouraging exploration and backtracking.

3. Combining Colours

With more orbs, puzzles require combining abilities (e.g. Cyan speed into Yellow jump to reach a distant platform), and combat requires quickly recognising enemy colours and switching to the correct counter.

4. Restoring the World

Near the end, the player holds every colour and the environment finally resembles a fully coloured comic world. The player reaches the source of the darkness to restore light to everything, leading directly into the twist.

Narrative and Plot Twist

The player believes collecting all Light Orbs will restore the world, and grows stronger with each colour. But the protagonist has not been carrying the orbs; they have been **absorbing** them. The world hasn't regained its colour because the light is trapped inside the protagonist. Restoring it requires releasing all the light at once, which will destroy the protagonist. The finale becomes a deliberate sacrifice: the player activates every colour one last time and releases them. For the first time, the entire screen is fully coloured and the world is restored, but the protagonist disappears with the light. The final scene shows the coloured world continuing without them.

Theme Justification

Comic

Comic forms the visual identity: comic-book printing techniques, especially halftone dots and CMYK printing, define environments, enemies, effects and characters. Presentation can include panel-style transitions, speech bubbles, sound effects (BAM, WHOOSH, CRACK), impact frames in combat, printed-paper textures and limited palettes. The theme is tied directly to the colour-based mechanics, not just the visuals.

Light

The world begins without light or colour and the goal is to recover the Light Orbs. Light determines what can be interacted with, which objects are active, which abilities the player has, how enemies are defeated and how the environment changes. The world visibly transitions from dark monochrome to a vibrant CMYK comic world throughout the game, not just in the story.

Twist

The player expects collecting all orbs to save the world, but learns the protagonist absorbed the light and must sacrifice themselves to release it. The colours that kept making the protagonist stronger become the reason they must give themselves up, changing the meaning of the player's progression.

Summary

PRIMARY is a comic-inspired 2D action-puzzle platformer where colour functions as light, movement, combat and progression. CMYK colours and halftone printing tie the visual design directly to the mechanics as the player restores colour, gains movement abilities, unlocks environmental interactions and defeats colour-based enemies. **Comic:** the halftone/CMYK visual identity. **Light:** the missing Light Orbs and gradual restoration of colour. **Twist:** restoring the world requires the protagonist's sacrifice.